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Tax & Depreciation Essentials Checklist — Investors (Western Australia)

What to have in place, and what's changing, before you lodge your next return.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — this is NOT financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or tax agent for advice specific to your situation.

Section 1 — Records to Keep From Day One

- [ ] **A tax depreciation schedule from a qualified quantity surveyor** — Division 43 (building) and Division 40 (plant and equipment) deductions.
- [ ] **Receipts for repairs vs. improvements — kept separately.** Repairs are often immediately deductible; improvements form part of your CGT cost base.
- [ ] **RevenueWA land tax assessments** — keep every annual assessment.
- [ ] **Stamp duty receipts.**
- [ ] **Records of your accountant fees and depreciation schedule costs.**

Section 2 — Western Australia Land Tax Obligations

- [ ] **Check whether you're above the threshold.** Land tax applies once your aggregated taxable WA land value exceeds **$300,000**.
- [ ] **Understand land tax is assessed against your combined WA landholdings**, not property-by-property.
- [ ] **Know WA's distinctive foreign-investor position.** Unlike NSW, VIC, and QLD, WA currently has **no separate foreign owner land tax surcharge** — a genuinely favourable feature for foreign investors comparing acquisition costs across states, though this settled position should be reconfirmed periodically given other states have moved to introduce or increase such surcharges.
- [ ] **If your property is in metropolitan Perth, factor in the Metropolitan Region Improvement Tax (MRIT)** — 0.14% on the value above $300,000, charged in addition to standard land tax.

Section 3 — Understanding the Changing CGT Environment

- [ ] **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — confirm the finalised, current rules with your accountant.
- [ ] **If planning to sell, get advice on timing relative to the 2027 changeover** — the impact depends heavily on your specific purchase price, holding period, and expected gain.

Section 4 — Depreciation Schedule Timing

- [ ] **Get your depreciation schedule prepared as early as possible after settlement.**
- [ ] **Update it after any renovations or major asset additions.**
- [ ] **Don't assume an older WA property has no deductions available** — plant and equipment deductions can still apply.

Section 5 — Questions to Bring to Your Accountant

- [ ] What is my current WA land tax position across all my WA landholdings combined, including any MRIT exposure if I'm in metro Perth?
- [ ] How will the 2027 CGT changes affect a future sale of this property, given my purchase price and expected holding period?
- [ ] Is my depreciation schedule up to date with any renovations or asset purchases since it was last prepared?

Quick Reference — WA Investor Tax Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold	$300,000
Foreign owner land tax surcharge	None (WA currently has no separate surcharge)
Metropolitan Region Improvement Tax	0.14% above $300,000, Perth metro only
CGT discount changes	Cost-base indexation + minimum tax from 1 July 2027
Depreciation schedule	Div 40 (plant/equipment) + Div 43 (building) — quantity surveyor required